

PCT PROFESSIONAL SERVICES LLC

CONTRACTOR SUCCESS GUIDE

From client intake to FILED / TRANSMITTED

THE SIMPLE RULE

Agent Portal = manage the client, workflow, communication, signatures, payment steps, status, and earnings. Tax Software = prepare, calculate, diagnose, and electronically transmit the tax return.

A practical job aid for independent contractor tax preparers working with PCT.

Use this guide while you work. Press Ctrl + F at any time and search the exact word or phrase you need: PTF, REJECTED, CLIENT LINK, TAX SOFTWARE, PAYMENT, DIRECT DEPOSIT, MESSAGES, SUPPORT, EARNINGS, or FILED.

Version: September 2026 • Designed for the live PCT Agent Portal workflow

START HERE. How to Use This Guide

This is a job aid, not a textbook. Find the step you need, do it, then come back when the next status changes.

CTRL + F QUICK FIND

In Microsoft Word press Ctrl + F, then type any bold search term from this guide. Word will jump straight to the section. You can also use Word's Navigation Pane because every major topic uses real heading styles.

Three rules that prevent most mistakes

1. Do the return work in the right system. Prepare and transmit in Tax Software. Manage the client and workflow in the Agent Portal.
2. Never treat Permission to File as the same thing as Filed. A signed PTF only gives permission. The return is FILED / TRANSMITTED only after you actually transmit it through Tax Software.
3. Never treat Accepted as Funded. IRS acceptance confirms the return was accepted for processing. Funding happens later, after funds are released or the client payment clears.

Quick Find Index

SEARCH THIS	YOU WILL FIND
NEW INTAKE	What to do when a client first submits your personalized link
CLIENT LINK	How to copy, text, email, open, or share your permanent client intake link
TAX SOFTWARE	When to leave the Agent Portal and work in the tax preparation system
DOCUMENT REQUEST	How to ask for missing forms or information securely
DUE DILIGENCE	Where to record required questions, answers, and notes
PAYMENT	When payment is handled and what to do if the client has not paid
PTF	Permission to File — when to send it, when to wait, and what signed means
FILED	The exact point when you mark FILED / TRANSMITTED
REJECTED	What to do when PCT records an IRS/state rejection
EARNINGS	Expected, funded, processing, paid, and direct deposit
MESSAGES / SUPPORT	Secure client replies, agent support, and escalation
DIRECT DEPOSIT	How payout setup and update requests work

1. The One-Page Return Roadmap

Follow this order for every assigned return unless a PCT workflow message tells you otherwise.

#	STAGE	WORK HERE	YOUR ACTION	DONE WHEN
1	CLIENT SUBMITS INTAKE	Agent Portal	Open the new assigned return and review the client's intake, tax year, documents, and missing items.	You know what you have and what is still missing.
2	REVIEW + REQUEST	Agent Portal	Review documents, request missing items, verify identity/dependents/IP PIN information, and document due diligence.	File is ready to prepare.
3	PREPARE RETURN	Tax Software	Enter tax data, run diagnostics, resolve errors, and prepare the return.	Return is calculation-ready for client review.
4	SAVE RESULT + FEES	Agent Portal	Record the return result, approved preparation fees, and any allowed additional services.	Client-facing review amount is correct.
5	CLIENT REVIEW + PAYMENT	Agent Portal / Client Portal	Send the existing review/access process. Client reviews, pays or selects the available payment method, and completes required signatures.	All required client actions are complete except PTF, if still outstanding.
6	PERMISSION TO FILE	Agent Portal	Send PTF only after the return is ready for authorization. Wait for RECEIVED / COMPLETED.	Signed PTF is on the same return.
7	FINALIZE + TRANSMIT	Tax Software	Do your final review and actually transmit the tax return.	Tax software confirms the transmission step was completed.
8	MARK FILED / TRANSMITTED	Agent Portal	Return to the same client record and confirm FILED / TRANSMITTED.	PCT can now track official return statuses.
9	PCT STATUS UPDATES	Agent Portal	PCT updates Accepted, Rejected, Funded, and other filing/funding statuses as available.	You act only when a status requires you.
10	EARNINGS + PAYOUT	Agent Portal	Track expected earnings, funding, processing, and paid status.	Direct deposit is issued after eligible cleared funds are processed.

DO NOT SKIP AHEAD

The biggest workflow risk is transmitting before the client's required signatures and Permission to File are complete. If the PTF still says AWAITING CLIENT, do not mark the return filed.

2. Agent Portal Feature Map

Know where to go before you start clicking around.

FEATURE	WHERE TO FIND IT	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
Tax Returns	Main Agent Portal / default workspace	Your assigned client returns, return workflow, documents, review steps, fees, signatures, filing actions.	Use this for almost every client.
Profile Setup	Agent Center → Profile Setup	Display name, business name, phone, professional email, website, photo, booking link, and current profile information.	Update public-facing information.
Share My Client Link	Agent Center → Share My Client Link	Your permanent personalized PCT client intake link. Copy, open, email, text, or share it.	Send this to clients who need to start with you.
Earnings	Agent Center → Earnings	Expected earnings, pending funding, funded, processing, paid YTD, statements, fines/disputes, and direct-deposit status.	Track money after returns move through payment/funding.

FEATURE	WHERE TO FIND IT	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
Messages / Support	Agent Center → Messages / Support	Client conversations, agent support conversations, secure replies, and linked return context.	Use for client communication and PCT help.
Referral Circle	Agent Center → Referral Circle	Share your preparer/referral invitation with Copy, Text, Email, or Share.	Use for recruiting/referrals — NOT for client tax intake.
Notifications Bell	Top-right of Agent Portal	Actionable alerts for new intake, new message, and Permission to File received.	Check it every time you log in.
Tax Software Access	Agent Portal → Tax Software Access	Your tax-software username, secure login link, and credential guidance.	Open when you are ready to prepare or transmit.
Permission to File	Agent Portal → Permission to File / return workspace	Signed PTF submissions for assigned returns.	Use before transmitting a return.
Onboarding / PTIN	Agent setup area	W-9, disclosures, agreement, PTIN verification/renewal, and direct-deposit setup.	Use when PCT requests setup or annual renewal action.

PERSONALIZED LINK RULE

Your client link is permanent. Updating your public profile does not change the link. Always use the link shown in Share My Client Link; do not manually invent a different URL.

3. Email & Notification Guide

Email gets your attention. The secure portal is where the work belongs.

Subject wording can vary slightly as PCT templates are updated. Match the email by its purpose and action. Never send Social Security numbers, full dates of birth, bank account information, tax documents, or passwords through ordinary email.

A. Emails you may receive as a PCT contractor

EMAIL / ALERT	WHEN IT HAPPENS	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Email Verification / Account Verification	After account creation	Verify the email address used for your PCT account.	Open the verification link. Return to the PCT enrollment page and continue the setup flow.
Enrollment Payment Reminder — 4 Hour	If enrollment payment is still incomplete	Your contractor enrollment is not yet paid.	Return to the enrollment page and complete payment. The reminders stop after payment is confirmed.
Enrollment Payment Reminder — 24 Hour	If still unpaid	Second reminder that setup is waiting on payment.	Complete payment or return to your account to continue.
Enrollment Payment Reminder — 72 Hour	If still unpaid	Final scheduled abandoned-payment reminder in the current sequence.	Complete payment if you still want to continue onboarding.
Agent Portal Access / Activation	After training/certification is completed and your account is activated	Your contractor access is active.	Use the Agent Portal sign-in link and keep it bookmarked.
Tax Software Credentials	When PCT creates your tax-software account	Contains the credentials/instructions you need to access Tax Software.	Save the email securely. Your password is not displayed in the Agent Portal.
Direct Deposit Invitation	After PCT sends payout setup	Invites you to complete secure bank setup with the approved external provider.	Use the secure provider. Do not email bank account/routing numbers to PCT.
PTIN Review / Correction / Renewal Notice	When PCT needs current PTIN information or a correction	Tells you what is missing, needs correction, or must be renewed.	Open the Agent setup/PTIN section and submit the requested current-year proof.
New Client Intake	When a new client is assigned through your personalized link	A new return needs review.	Open Tax Returns and start with the intake/document review.
New Client Message	When a client sends a secure portal message	A client conversation needs attention.	Open Messages / Support or the linked return and reply securely.
Permission to File Received	After the client signs the current PTF	The PTF step is RECEIVED / COMPLETED for that return.	Open the same return, do your final tax-software review, transmit, then mark FILED / TRANSMITTED.
Agent Support Reply / PCT Message	When PCT responds to an Agent Support conversation	Your support question has an update.	Open Messages / Support and continue the secure thread.
Return Status / Rejection Action	When PCT records a status that needs your attention, if email notification is sent	The portal status is the source of truth.	Open the exact return. If REJECTED, read the rejection reason and correct only what is required.

B. Client-facing emails triggered by the return workflow

CLIENT EMAIL	WHAT TRIGGERS IT	WHAT CLIENT SEES	YOUR ROLE
Return Review / Access Code	You send the client review step from the return workspace.	Gives the client secure access to review the prepared return information and required actions.	Do not send sensitive return data in your own email. Use the PCT-generated secure access flow.
Document Request	You request missing documents or information.	Tells the client there is a secure request waiting.	Write a clear request in the portal. Review the submission when it comes back.

CLIENT EMAIL	WHAT TRIGGERS IT	WHAT CLIENT SEES	YOUR ROLE
Preparation Fee / Payment Link	The workflow requires the client to pay directly.	Takes the client to the approved payment experience.	Use the portal payment action/resend option. Do not collect card details yourself.
Secure Message Notification	You reply to the client in Messages.	Alerts the client that a secure portal message is waiting.	Keep sensitive details in the portal thread; email only tells them to log in.
Permission to File Request	The confirmed return is ready for client filing authorization.	Tells the client to review/sign the current PTF.	Wait until the PTF is actually signed. Do not treat "sent" as "signed."
Return Copy / Access	The client requests or you provide a return-copy access step.	Provides the approved secure method for the client to receive the copy.	Use the portal return-copy workflow rather than regular email attachments.
Status Updates	PCT updates official return statuses after filing.	Keeps the client informed when configured for that status.	If the client asks questions, check the portal status before answering.

EMAIL SECURITY

Email notifications should not contain sensitive tax data. If a client emails you a tax document anyway, direct them back to the secure PCT portal and do not continue sensitive tax-data conversations in ordinary email.

4. Getting Into the Systems

Bookmark the two places you will use most.

PCT Agent Portal

Agent Portal: <https://www.pctquickfile.com/agent-portal/>

- Sign in with your PCT contractor account.
- Use Forgot password? if needed. Enter your email first, then request the reset link.
- Keep "Remember this device" checked only on a trusted private device.
- If you are not fully activated or your annual PTIN verification is incomplete, the portal may show setup actions before production work.

Tax Software

Tax Software Login: [Open Tax Software](#)

- Open Tax Software from the Agent Portal when you are ready to prepare, diagnose, finalize, or transmit a return.
- Your username can be shown in the Agent Portal. Your password is delivered by email when your tax-software account is created and is not displayed in the portal.
- Never share your Tax Software credentials with a client or another preparer.

Helpful tax-software resources

[Tax Software Help Center](#)

[Where Do I Enter?](#)

IF YOU ARE STUCK

First identify whether the problem is a tax-preparation question or a PCT workflow question. Tax-preparation/data-entry questions usually belong in the Tax Software Help Center. Client workflow, permissions, payments, PTF, messages, or portal problems belong in Agent Support.

5. Profile Setup + Your Personalized Client Link

Your profile tells clients who you are. Your personalized link tells PCT which contractor owns the intake.

Profile Setup

1. Open Agent Center → Profile Setup.
2. Review your professional display name, business name, phone number, professional email, website, profile photo, and optional booking link.
3. Upload a clear PNG, JPEG, or WEBP profile photo. The portal currently accepts files up to 3 MB.
4. Use Save & Publish so the public profile is updated.
5. Your permanent publicAgentId/client link does not change when you update your profile.

Share My Client Link

1. Open Agent Center → Share My Client Link.
2. Use the PCT-generated link shown there. The canonical format is <https://www.pctquickfile.com/start/?pro=YOUR-PUBLIC-AGENT-ID>.
3. Choose Copy Link, Open, Email, Text, QR, or the available share action depending on the device/browser.
4. If you use a booking link, save a valid HTTPS booking URL in your profile/share settings.
5. When the client submits through your personalized link, the return is assigned to you and appears in Tax Returns.

DO NOT CONFUSE THESE LINKS

Share My Client Link = clients who want you to prepare their return. Referral Circle = people you are referring/recruiting as preparers. Never send the Referral Circle link to a tax client by mistake.

6. Exact Contractor Return Workflow

This is the step-by-step process to use for a normal PCT client return from intake through transmission.

STEP 1 — New Intake: open the assigned return

1. Check the notification bell for New Intake or open Tax Returns.
2. Find the client in your assigned return list and open the return workspace.
3. Confirm the client name, tax year, contact information, filing situation, dependents, documents submitted, and any notes from intake.
4. If the return is not actually assigned to you, do not work it. Contact Agent Support.

DONE WITH STEP 1 WHEN

You understand what the client submitted and have a clear list of what is present, missing, unclear, or needs follow-up.

STEP 2 — Review documents and request what is missing

1. Open and review the client's documents from the return workspace. Use the document viewer and extracted information as an aid, but verify the source document yourself.
2. Make a missing-items list: W-2s, 1099s, 1098s, Schedule C records, marketplace forms, dependent information, IP PINs, identity information, or other required support.
3. Use Document Request for missing information instead of asking the client to email sensitive forms.
4. When the client uploads the requested information, open the submission and review it before continuing.
5. Do not mark a request resolved until you actually reviewed the response.

STEP 3 — Complete due diligence before and while preparing

Good due diligence notes explain what caused the question, what you asked, what the client told you, what documentation you reviewed, and how you resolved the issue. They should be specific enough that another reviewer can understand why the return was prepared the way it was.

- **Write the issue:** Example — filing status, qualifying child, EITC/CTC/AOTC, self-employment income, residency, support, or document inconsistency.
- **Write the question asked:** Record the actual clarification you requested.
- **Write the client response:** Summarize the answer accurately; do not change it to make the return work.
- **Write what you reviewed:** Identify the supporting document or information used.
- **Write the resolution:** Explain the tax treatment you used and why.

DUE DILIGENCE STANDARD

"Client said yes" by itself is usually not a useful compliance note. Record enough detail to show what was asked, what was answered, and what supported the conclusion.

STEP 4 — Open Tax Software and prepare the return

1. Use Tax Software Access in the Agent Portal and open the approved tax-software link in a new tab.
2. Log in with your tax-software credentials.
3. Start/open the correct client and tax year.
4. Enter the verified information from the client and source documents.
5. Enter dependents, filing status, IP PINs, income, adjustments, credits, deductions, bank/refund selections, and all required forms exactly as supported by the client file.

6. Run the software diagnostics. Resolve errors and review warnings that require preparer judgment.
7. Review federal and state results before you move back to the Agent Portal.

STOP BEFORE TRANSMISSION

Preparing the return is not permission to file it. Do not transmit yet unless the required PCT client review, payment/signature steps, and Permission to File are complete.

STEP 5 — Record the return result, fees, and additional services in the Agent Portal

1. Return to the same client return workspace in the Agent Portal.
2. Save the return result using the existing return-review/result workflow.
3. Confirm the PCT preparation fees and allowed additional services shown for the return.
4. Use only the approved portal pricing/discount controls. Do not create side invoices or collect off-system card information.
5. Make sure the client-facing amount is correct before sending the review step.

STEP 6 — Send the client review / access step

1. Use the existing client review/access-code action from the return workspace.
2. The client receives the approved secure review email/access process.
3. The client reviews the return information, payment requirement, agreements, and signature steps in the Client Portal.
4. If the client reports something wrong, reopen the return, correct it in Tax Software, then update the Agent Portal result before asking the client to approve again.

STEP 7 — Confirm payment and required signatures

1. Check the return's financial/payment section in the Agent Portal.
2. If the client must pay directly, use the portal payment link/resend action. Never ask for card numbers by phone, email, or portal message.
3. If the approved pay-by-refund/bank-product option applies, follow the available workflow shown for that return.
4. Verify required signatures/authorizations are complete before proceeding to Permission to File.

PAYMENT RULE

A return being prepared, reviewed, or even accepted by the client does not automatically mean the preparation fee has funded. Follow the portal's payment/funding status.

STEP 8 — Permission to File (PTF)

1. When the return is fully prepared and ready for filing authorization, use the existing PCT document/signature workflow to send Permission to File.
2. The overall return can remain in its waiting/review status while PTF is unsigned. That is normal.
3. Wait. An unsigned PTF does not appear as a completed submission.
4. After the client signs, the Agent Portal shows the same return in Permission to File as RECEIVED / COMPLETED.
5. Use Open Submission if you need to review the signed PTF, then Open Tax Return to return to the same client record.

PTF DOES NOT FILE THE RETURN

RECEIVED / COMPLETED means the authorization document is signed. It does not change the overall return to Completed and does not transmit anything to the IRS/state.

STEP 9 — Finalize and transmit in Tax Software

1. Open the same client in Tax Software.
2. Perform a final review after PTF: names, SSNs, filing status, dependents, IP PINs, income, credits, bank/refund selections, federal/state forms, diagnostics, and e-file readiness.
3. Correct any last issue before transmission. If the change affects what the client approved, stop and use the appropriate review/signature workflow again.
4. Transmit the return through Tax Software.
5. Confirm Tax Software indicates the return was transmitted/submitted before going back to the Agent Portal.

STEP 10 — Mark FILED / TRANSMITTED in the Agent Portal

1. Return to the same client return workspace.
2. Use the FILED / TRANSMITTED action and confirm that you actually transmitted the return through Tax Software.
3. This updates the return to FILED and sends it into PCT's return status tracking workflow.
4. Do not manually call the return "Accepted." Accepted happens only after the official filing status is received/recorded.

CRITICAL STATUS RULE

FILED = you transmitted it. ACCEPTED = IRS/state accepted it. REJECTED = IRS/state rejected it. FUNDED = funds were released/cleared. These are different events.

STEP 11 — After filing: watch statuses, not the IRS for the client

1. PCT updates the return status as filing information becomes available.
2. If the return becomes ACCEPTED, no correction is needed unless another status says otherwise.
3. If the return becomes REJECTED, open the return and read the rejection code/reason and client action steps, if provided.
4. Correct the exact rejection issue in Tax Software. Re-review anything that changed. Re-transmit as appropriate.
5. If the return is still pending, do not promise a refund date. Use the portal status and approved IRS/state tools when needed.

STEP 12 — Funding and earnings

1. Open Agent Center → Earnings.
2. Track the return from Expected Earnings/Pending Funding to Funded, Processing, and Paid.
3. Remember: Accepted is not Funded. Funding means the eligible payment/refund funds actually cleared or were received.
4. PCT processes eligible contractor commissions within approximately 3 business days after cleared funds, according to the current portal guidance.

7. Status Decoder

Read the status first. Then take only the action that status requires.

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS	YOUR NEXT ACTION
NEW LEAD / NEW INTAKE	A client started/submitted through your personalized link.	Open the return and review the intake/documents.
ESTIMATE ONLY	The client may have started with estimate information but has not completed the full return workflow.	Review what is available; do not assume filing readiness.

STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS	YOUR NEXT ACTION
QUOTE SENT / WAITING	Client-facing review/payment/signature steps are still in progress.	Wait or follow up through the approved portal action.
PTF — AWAITING CLIENT	Permission to File was not yet signed.	Do not transmit. Follow up if needed.
PTF — RECEIVED / COMPLETED	Client signed the current Permission to File for that return.	Final review in Tax Software → transmit → mark FILED.
FILED / TRANSMITTED	You transmitted the return through Tax Software and confirmed it in PCT.	Wait for official filing statuses. Do not call it accepted yet.
ACCEPTED	IRS/state accepted the filing for processing.	Continue status/funding tracking; no correction unless another status says so.
REJECTED	IRS/state rejected the filing.	Read reason/code → correct exact issue → re-review → re-transmit when appropriate.
FUNDED	Eligible client payment/refund funds were released or cleared.	Watch Earnings for payout processing.
PROCESSING	PCT is processing the contractor payout.	No action unless PCT requests information.
PAID	Direct deposit was issued.	Confirm the payout in your records/bank.

REJECTED IS NOT A FAILURE

A rejection is a filing response that requires correction. Read the exact rejection information, fix only what is needed, and document any client clarification. Never guess at a rejection reason.

8. Agent Portal vs. Tax Software

When you are unsure where something belongs, use this chart.

TASK	AGENT PORTAL	TAX SOFTWARE
Client intake and assigned return list	YES	NO
Open/view client documents	YES	Use data after verification
Document requests	YES	NO
Secure client messages	YES	NO
Due diligence record/notes workflow	YES	Tax questions may also require entries/forms
Enter W-2/1099/credits/deductions	NO	YES
Run tax calculations and diagnostics	NO	YES
Return result and PCT fee workflow	YES	Use tax result as source
Client review/access code	YES	NO
Preparation-fee payment workflow	YES	NO
Permission to File	YES	NO
Electronic transmission to IRS/state	NO	YES
Mark FILED / TRANSMITTED	YES — after transmission	Transmission happens here first

TASK	AGENT PORTAL	TAX SOFTWARE
Accepted/Rejected/Funded tracking	YES	Tax software may show transmission responses, but PCT portal is the contractor workflow record
Earnings/direct deposit status	YES	NO

9. Messages, Agent Support & Escalation

Use secure communication first. Email is the backup/escalation path, not the place for tax documents.

Client Messages

- Open Agent Center → Messages / Support → Client Messages.
- Select the conversation. The linked client/return context appears with the thread when available.
- Reply inside the secure portal. Email notifications tell the client a message is waiting but should not include sensitive tax data.
- If a client asks about a status, open the actual return before answering.

Agent Support

- Use Agent Support when the problem is about the PCT workflow, client assignment, portal access, payment state, signatures/PTF, filing status workflow, document request, earnings, or another PCT process.
- When asking for help, include the client name/initials and return ID if available, what page you are on, the exact error message, and what you already tried.
- Do not put SSNs, full DOBs, bank account/routing numbers, passwords, or full tax documents in ordinary email.

Email PCT when you need direct escalation

PCT Owner/Admin Email: shaylah455@gmail.com

Use email for escalation or when the portal support route is unavailable. Keep the email high-level and move sensitive case details back into the secure portal.

BEST SUPPORT MESSAGE

“Client: A.B. / Return ID 12345. I am in the Permission to File step. The portal says AWAITING CLIENT even though the client says they signed today. I refreshed and reopened the return. Can you verify the current PTF status?” This gives support enough context without putting sensitive tax data in email.

10. Earnings, Funding & Direct Deposit

The Earnings page is for tracking — not guessing.

What the Earnings boxes mean

EARNINGS STATUS	MEANING
Expected Earnings	Projected contractor share on returns that have not yet funded.
Pending Funding	The return may be accepted or otherwise progressing, but eligible funds have not cleared.
Funded	Eligible invoice/refund funds have cleared or been received.
Processing	PCT is processing the contractor payout.
Paid YTD	Direct deposit has been issued and counted in paid earnings.

- PCT's current contractor compensation model is an 80/20 split on eligible preparation fees, subject to the return's final pricing, adjustments, and the contractor agreement.
- The portal currently states that PCT processes commissions within approximately 3 business days after cleared funds.
- Use Download Statement when you need your earnings detail for your records.
- If an admin adjustment or fine appears, review the reason. Use the dispute option within the allowed dispute window when appropriate.

Direct Deposit

- Complete direct deposit only through the approved secure external provider/invitation.
- PCT does not need you to send full bank account numbers, routing numbers, or bank login credentials by email or portal message.
- If your bank information changes, use UPDATE DIRECT DEPOSIT / the direct-deposit update request in the Earnings area.
- Safe portal display may show limited status information such as bank name or last four digits; it should not expose full credentials.

11. Referral Circle

Use this for preparer referrals — never for client tax intake.

- Open Agent Center → Referral Circle.
- Use the available Copy, Text, Email, or Share action to send the preparer/referral invitation.
- Text sharing uses your device/browser's normal SMS function; PCT is not sending an automated SMS on your behalf from this feature.
- A person who wants tax preparation should receive your Share My Client Link instead, not your Referral Circle link.

CLIENT OR PREPARER?

Client wants taxes prepared → Share My Client Link. Person wants to join/refer as a preparer → Referral Circle.

12. “What Do I Do Next?” Troubleshooting

Search the situation that matches what is happening right now.

SITUATION	NEXT MOVE
A new client just submitted	Open notification → Tax Returns → open intake → review documents and missing items.
Client started but did not finish	Review current status. Use the approved follow-up/reminder path; do not invent a new return.
Client is missing a document	Use Document Request. Be specific about what is needed and why.
Client emailed me a W-2	Do not keep tax-document handling in ordinary email. Direct the client to the secure PCT portal/document request.
I do not know where to enter a form	Use Tax Software Help Center / Where Do I Enter? Then ask Agent Support if the issue is a PCT workflow question.
Client says the return result is wrong	Stop. Reopen Tax Software, verify/correct data, update the Agent Portal result, then resend/re-review as required.
Client has not paid	Check payment status. Use the portal payment link/resend action. Do not collect card details yourself.
Client has not signed PTF	PTF remains AWAITING CLIENT. Follow up through the secure process. Do not transmit.
PTF says RECEIVED / COMPLETED	Open same return → final Tax Software review → transmit → return to portal → mark FILED / TRANSMITTED.

SITUATION	NEXT MOVE
Tax Software transmitted, but I did not mark filed	Return to the exact client record and use FILED / TRANSMITTED. Confirm only if transmission truly occurred.
Return says FILED	Wait for official Accepted/Rejected status. FILED is not ACCEPTED.
Return says REJECTED	Read rejection code/reason → correct exact issue in Tax Software → update/re-review as needed → re-transmit.
Return says ACCEPTED	No correction needed unless another status says so. Track funding and client questions.
Return is accepted but earnings still pending	Normal. Accepted is not funded. Wait for cleared eligible funds.
My payout has not arrived	Check Earnings → funding/processing/paid status and direct-deposit status before contacting support.
My personalized link is not available	Open Share My Client Link. If the portal says the link is still being prepared, contact Agent Support; do not make up a URL.
I cannot log in	Use Forgot password? with the correct email. If access is still blocked, contact Agent Support/PCT Admin.
I need help now	Search this guide → check the linked return → use Messages / Support → email PCT Admin if escalation is needed.

13. Quality & Compliance Habits

Fast is good. Accurate, documented, and authorized is better.

- ☐ Work only assigned returns.
- ☐ Use current-year PTIN information and complete annual verification when required.
- ☐ Verify source documents; do not rely only on extracted/auto-read values.
- ☐ Document due diligence clearly enough for another reviewer to understand the decision.
- ☐ Never change client answers or facts just to make a credit, status, or refund work.
- ☐ Never send client tax documents, SSNs, bank data, or passwords through ordinary email/text.
- ☐ Use approved PCT pricing and fee controls.
- ☐ Do not transmit before all required review/signature/payment/PTF conditions are satisfied.
- ☐ Do not mark FILED unless you actually transmitted through Tax Software.
- ☐ Do not tell a client “Accepted” or “Funded” until the actual portal status supports it.
- ☐ If you are unsure, stop the return at its current safe step and ask Agent Support.

14. Return Completion Checklist

Print this page or Ctrl+F “CHECKLIST” whenever you want a final pre-file review.

- ☐ I confirmed this return is assigned to me.
- ☐ I reviewed the client intake and tax year.
- ☐ I reviewed all source documents and requested missing items.
- ☐ I verified filing status, dependents, residency/support facts, and required identity information.
- ☐ I confirmed IP PIN information where applicable.
- ☐ I completed clear due diligence notes for issues that required follow-up.
- ☐ I prepared the return in Tax Software from verified information.
- ☐ I ran diagnostics and resolved required errors/warnings.
- ☐ I reviewed federal and state results.
- ☐ I saved the correct return result and PCT fees in the Agent Portal.
- ☐ The client completed the required review/payment/signature steps.
- ☐ Permission to File shows RECEIVED / COMPLETED for this exact return.

Internal contractor job aid • Keep client tax data inside approved secure systems

- ☐ I performed a final Tax Software review after client authorization.
- ☐ I actually transmitted the return through Tax Software.
- ☐ I marked the same return FILED / TRANSMITTED in the Agent Portal.
- ☐ I understand FILED is not the same as ACCEPTED.
- ☐ I will check REJECTED status details before making any correction.
- ☐ I will track funding/earnings in the Earnings page instead of assuming payment from acceptance.

FINAL GO / NO-GO

If every required box through “PTF RECEIVED / COMPLETED” is not true, do not transmit. If you already transmitted, mark FILED / TRANSMITTED promptly so the PCT status workflow remains accurate.

APPENDIX. Quick Links & Search Terms

Keep this last page handy.

RESOURCE	ADDRESS / ACTION
PCT Agent Portal	https://www.pctquickfile.com/agent-portal/
PCT Client Portal	https://www.pctquickfile.com/client-portal/
Personalized Client Intake Format	https://www.pctquickfile.com/start/?pro=YOUR-PUBLIC-AGENT-ID
Tax Software	https://nto.cloudtaxoffice.com/proavalon/CoreLink/Index?ReturnUrl=%2fproavalon
Tax Software Help Center	https://support.taxprosoftwaretraining.com/portal/en/home
Where Do I Enter?	https://support.taxprosoftwaretraining.com/portal/en/kb/where-do-i-enter
PCT Owner/Admin Email	shaylah455@gmail.com

Best Ctrl + F search terms

ACCESS CODE • ACCEPTED • ADDITIONAL SERVICES • CLIENT LINK • CLIENT MESSAGE • DIRECT DEPOSIT • DOCUMENT REQUEST • DUE DILIGENCE • EARNINGS • FILED • FUNDED • IP PIN • MESSAGES • PAYMENT • PROFILE SETUP • PTF • REFERRAL CIRCLE • REJECTED • RETURN COPY • SUPPORT • TAX SOFTWARE • TRANSMITTED

PCT CONTRACTOR SUCCESS STANDARD

Prepare carefully. Communicate securely. Get client authorization. Transmit only when ready. Mark FILED accurately. Let the portal statuses tell you what comes next. Ask for help before guessing.